PROGRESS REPORT

Zambia: progress report, October 2025 – October 2026

Edition of 2026-10-12 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS · WHERE THE RECORD IS THIN

This report asks the same set of questions of every country. The rows below are a fixed frame of indicators, one row each, chosen in advance and covering all thirty-eight subjects the repository tracks — so what appears here is decided by the frame and not by whichever records happened to accumulate. Each row says what happened on that indicator during the period, with every claim linked to the source it rests on.

Where a row reads *No evidence*, the repository holds nothing on that indicator. **That is a statement about this repository, not about the country** — it does not mean nothing exists, only that nothing has been collected here yet. The rows that carry evidence say what it is; the rows that do not are left to speak for themselves.

The period is 2025-10-01 to 2026-10-12.

Progress values. *Movement* — some form of progress, however minor, has been recorded. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a reported position worsened. *Mixed* — the indicator's instruments moved in different directions in the period; the clause after the comma names which moved which way. *No change* — the repository holds a standing position and nothing in the period touched it. *No evidence* — the repository holds nothing on this indicator at all. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Movement, regulations still pending*.

Governance

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	**Digital transformation strategy**	The 2023-2027 strategy is in force and its implementation now reports against measured connectivity, with bulk international bandwidth out to bid. The National Digital Transformation Strategy 2023-2027 sets out five digital-transformation pillars and is the standing instrument. 2026-02-25 — the acceleration project invited bids for pre-purchase of bulk dedicated international bandwidth capacity for the one government network, a concrete implementation step rather than a plan. 2026-05-14 — the third digital economy round table recorded 94 per cent connectivity coverage, quarterly public quality-of-service reporting and K255 million approved for network-quality upgrades. The strategy is being reported against connectivity numbers; no progress measure against its own five pillars is published. 2026-09-10 - the new term's Grow Zambia Agenda 2026-2031 carries eight digital-infrastructure targets, with a real-time Cabinet monitoring dashboard being built; the targets themselves are not published.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	**ICT strategy**	The 2023 ICT policy is in force, with towers reported growing from 3,568 to 3,751 and coverage at 95 per cent. The National Information and Communication Technology Policy 2023 is the overarching instrument, revising the 2006 policy. 2026-04 — an official progress statement reported towers growing from 3,568 in 2023 to 3,751 in 2025, average mobile population coverage of 95 per cent, and 14.7 million internet subscriptions in 2025. The figures are the delivery unit's own and they measure infrastructure rather than policy delivery: no target from the policy is quoted, and no evaluation of it as an instrument is held. Procurement of bulk international bandwidth for the government network is the one implementing step in the window.	MOVEMENT
Strategies, plans and policies	**Broadband strategy**	A national event's working group concluded that the country lacks a national broadband policy and recommended formulating one. The policy working group at a national broadband mapping event concluded that Zambia lacks a national broadband policy and recommended that one be formulated. It is a dated statement of absence by a group convened for the purpose, which is stronger evidence than a failed search. Delivery continues without it. 109 post offices were converted into digital transformation centres with high-speed internet, linked to a goal of connecting 800,000 people to affordable broadband by 2026, and a round table recorded 94 per cent connectivity coverage and K255 million approved for network-quality upgrades. Targets are being reported against; the instrument that would set them does not exist.	NO CHANGE
Strategies, plans and policies	**Data storage / cloud strategy**	A memorandum was signed to co-invest in a national artificial-intelligence data centre, and the state operator tendered for 150TB and GPU capacity. A government cloud is treated as a planned component of the national electronic government plan's enterprise architecture rather than as a standalone strategy, and no such strategy exists. 2026-05-26 — the state technology institute and a vendor signed a memorandum to co-invest in a national artificial-intelligence data centre, announced at a mobile congress. 2026-06 — the state telecommunications and data-centre operator advertised a tender for 150TB storage engines and a GPU-accelerated server platform. Capacity is being bought before the strategy that would place it is written; no siting, ownership or hosting-policy statement accompanies either.	MOVEMENT
Strategies, plans and policies	**Data interoperability framework / roadmap**	A 2019 interoperability standard was extended by a spatial data infrastructure policy and geoportal launched in June 2026. The public service electronic government interoperability standard, first edition 2019, is the country's own national instrument — the framework the rest of the estate is meant to connect through. 2026-06 — a national spatial data infrastructure policy for 2026-2030 and a national geoportal were launched on open-source software, with the electronic government division as lead authority. It extends interoperability to geospatial data, which government describes as ending fragmentation across agencies. What neither carries is a compliance record: no count of systems conforming to the 2019 standard, and no obligation on any agency to join the geoportal, is held.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	**AI strategy**	The National AI Strategy text was located in the copy lodged with an international policy observatory, and the ministry says the strategy is nearing the end of its cycle and due for review. The document carries no date of its own — no adoption date and no month in 121,000 characters of extracted text — and is dated here from the ministry's own launch announcement (text). It disagrees with itself about its horizon: the cover reads 2024-2026 and every running header reads 2025-2027. No first-party copy was located (text). The permanent secretary said in August 2026 that the strategy is nearing the end of its cycle and due for review; a successor reading is an inference from the dates and is stated in no source held (review, partnership, leadership). A regional artificial-intelligence strategy sensitisation workshop was launched in the capital: the country is drafting a national instrument while helping shape the regional one that would frame it (regional).	MIXED a strategy text located and held while the document carries no date of its own and disagrees with itself about its horizon
Strategies, plans and policies	**Data localisation policies**	Localisation is being procured rather than legislated: ministry workloads hosted locally under a kwacha agreement and domestic storage tendered. The data protection statute carries a cross-border transfer regime at sections 70 and 71 rather than a localisation mandate, and no instrument requires data to be held in Zambia. 2025-10 — a partnership between the state technology institute and two operators put a platform in place for ministries to design, scale and host digital solutions locally under a kwacha-denominated service agreement. 2026-06 — the state operator tendered for 150TB of storage and GPU-accelerated capacity in country. What is emerging is de facto localisation through procurement and pricing, which is a weaker and more reversible thing than a rule — and no policy statement connects the two.	MOVEMENT
Strategies, plans and policies	**Data governance policy**	A health-sector statutory instrument went to stakeholder review, and a spatial data policy adopted open by default for non-sensitive data. A data governance framework is a planned component of the national electronic government plan and has not been issued as an instrument of its own. 2025-09 — a two-day multi-stakeholder review examined a draft sector statutory instrument under the data protection statute, to give the 2024 health data governance framework legal enforceability. A sector instrument arriving before a national one is the pattern this row records. 2026-06 — the spatial data infrastructure policy was adopted with non-sensitive data open by default and the electronic government division as lead authority, which is a governance rule for one class of data rather than for data generally.	MOVEMENT
Strategies, plans and policies	**Open data policy**	The access-to-information proactive-disclosure framework is stated to be in final operationalisation, and spatial data is open by default. An open government data framework is a planned component of the national electronic government plan, not an adopted policy. 2026-06 — the national spatial data infrastructure policy was launched with non-sensitive data open by default, the first open-by-default rule the repository holds for Zambia and confined to geospatial data. 2026-07 — the information ministry stated that the access-to-information Act's proactive-disclosure framework, covering contracts, budgets, expenditure and development projects, is in its final operationalisation stage, following the 2025 regulations and the December guidelines. Proactive disclosure under an access statute is the nearest thing to an open data mandate here, and it is not yet operative.	MOVEMENT

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Legislation and regulation	**Data protection legislation**	The Data Protection Act 2021 is named as part of the operative framework, and a reported Cabinet repeal intent has produced nothing in sixteen months. The Act's number and year of enactment are not established beyond 2021, and the reported repeal intent has produced nothing on the record in sixteen months (framework, safeguards, freedom). A statute whose own enactment reference cannot be established, under a repeal intent that has produced nothing, is the legal basis under which the identity register, the health record and the refugee database all operate.	NO CHANGE
Legislation and regulation	**Cybersecurity legislation**	The Cyber Security Act No. 3 of 2025 and the Cyber Crimes Act No. 4 of 2025 are both in force, and the investigatory and interception powers in them are court-gated. The gazetted text of the security Act was acquired from the National Assembly's own directory; it commenced on 12 May 2025 by statutory instrument (Act, signature). Enforcement of the crimes Act was declared fully operational in July 2026. The gazetted texts of both Acts are now held, and the investigatory powers in the crimes Act and the interception power in the security Act are both court-gated; the claim that the 2025 Acts authorise interception without prior judicial review is not borne out, while the presidential-control half of that claim is (enforcement, warning, compliance, freedom). The Law Association was reported set to mount a challenge in April 2025; the single held source is a lede-only capture and the absence of any subsequent record is itself the finding (challenge).	MIXED two 2025 Acts in force with their investigatory powers court-gated while a threatened legal challenge has produced no record
Legislation and regulation	**Legislation covering digital id**	A statutory instrument amended the citizenship regulations while the registration department began computerising document issuance. 2025-12-31 — Statutory Instrument No. 98 of 2025 amended the citizenship regulations, the clearest in-window regulatory movement touching national identity documents. 2025-08 — the home affairs permanent secretary announced that the registration department has begun computerising national registration card, passport and citizenship-document issuance with the state technology institute, targeting online applications including from the diaspora. The instruments governing identity are being amended at the edges while the system beneath them is rebuilt; no consolidated digital identity statute is held, and the new register's legal basis remains the National Registration Act.	MOVEMENT
Legislation and regulation	**Digital payments legislation**	The mobile money levy rate doubled during 2025, dated only to the year, and the source is an industry body arguing against such levies. The doubling is dated only to the year, so it cannot be placed inside or outside the window (levy). Naming the source's interest matters here: an industry body arguing against mobile money levies is the only account of this one, and no government or regulator statement of the rate or its yield is held.	NO CHANGE
Legislation and regulation	**Legislation enabling data interoperability**	A Cabinet directive on open-source technology was issued to ministries, reported only in an excerpt of a trade-press article with no government publication held. It was issued alongside the spatial data infrastructure launch in June 2026 (directive). No government publication of it is held. Officials elsewhere in this ledger name fragmented, vendor-locked systems as a governance and legal problem rather than a technical one, which is the case the directive would answer — and the directive itself cannot be read.	MOVEMENT

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Legislation and regulation	**AI legislation / regulations**	No binding instrument; a readiness assessment methodology was piloted ahead of the national strategy's review before its end-2026 expiry. 2026-06-22 to 23 — a Lusaka consultation piloted an international readiness assessment methodology, ahead of the National AI Strategy's review before its end-2026 expiry. That is the whole of the movement, and the expiry is the part worth recording: the country's only artificial-intelligence instrument is a strategy that runs out at the end of this year, with no statute, statutory instrument or regulator rule behind it and no successor drafted. A readiness assessment is a diagnostic, not a rule.	NO CHANGE
Legislation and regulation	**E-commerce legislation**	A Postal and Courier Services Bill 2026 went to public written submissions, replacing a 2009 Act that also underwrites postal banking and financial services. Submissions closed on 27 July 2026 (bill, submissions). The 2009 Act underwrites postal banking and financial services, so its replacement governs the postal service's agency-banking role — which makes a postal bill a payments instrument. Submissions closed one working day after the consultations ended, and it is the only open public call for written comment on a domestic instrument the repository holds for the whole window (consultation). 2026-09-30 - the technology ministry opened consultations on amending the Electronic Communications and Transactions Act No. 4 of 2021, approved in principle by Cabinet in September 2025, to unblock licensing of certification providers and strengthen the national public key infrastructure; no draft text is published.	MOVEMENT
Legislation and regulation	**Statistics legislation**	The 2018 Act is operating on its own terms: a release calendar issued under section 27(1) and a Statistician-General appointed under section 11. Act No. 13 of 2018 establishes the statistics agency and the national statistical system and remains the operative framework. 2025-12 — a national statistical release calendar for 2026 was issued expressly under section 27(1) of the Act, operationalising its release-planning mandate. 2026-03-24 — a new Statistician-General was appointed, the statutory chief executive under section 11. Both are the statute working rather than changing, which is the more useful thing to record about a law eight years old: the offices it creates are filled and the duties it imposes are being discharged on schedule.	MOVEMENT
Legislation and regulation	**Access to information legislation**	The 2023 Act gained its first implementing regulations and then commission guidelines translating its duties into operational guidance. Act No. 24 of 2023 came into force on 25 June 2024, granting a citizen or residence-permit holder the right to access information held by an information holder. 2025-08-29 — Statutory Instrument No. 56 of 2025 supplied the request forms, fees and procedures needed to make the right operative — the step without which an access statute is unusable. 2025-12-05 — the rights commission issued guidelines as Government Notice No. 1624 of 2025, translating the Act's duties into operational guidance. Two years from enactment to a usable procedure is the shape of it. No count of requests made, granted or refused under the Act is published.	MOVEMENT

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Data protection	**Data protection authority**	The data protection commissioner was asked by nine civil-society organisations to examine a beneficiary contact list, and nothing in the repository shows the regulator acting. The regulator exists and travels — it appeared at an international identity event — and nothing in the repository shows it acting (commissioner, freedom, engagement). Tenders were opened in August 2026 for a data protection compliance management system and for guidelines consultancy; these are tenders rather than awards, with no value, delivery date or statement of the commission's current caseload or enforcement record held (tender, guidelines). A regulator with no recorded action, procuring the system that would let it record action, is the position.	NO CHANGE
Data protection	**National data protection readiness**	The Commissioner names registration as the first step and weak internal systems and limited awareness as continuing gaps. Act No. 3 of 2021 establishes the Office of the Data Protection Commissioner and, at sections 70 and 71, the cross-border transfer regime. 2026-06 — the Data Protection Commissioner went on record identifying registration of controllers as the necessary first step, and naming weak internal systems and limited awareness as continuing implementation gaps. A regulator publicly naming its own enforcement obstacles is a more useful record than a compliance statistic, and it is the only one available: no registration count, no enforcement notice and no penalty under the Act is held, five years after it was passed. 2026-10-07 - the technology ministry's permanent secretary said the country is implementing a national child online protection strategy for 2025 to 2029.	MOVEMENT
Regional collaboration	**Regional policy collaboration**	A national was elected Secretary-General of the continental telecommunications union on the fourth round, and the country gains the secretariat and loses the council seat in the same cycle. The election was won with 21 of 34 votes at a plenipotentiary conference, for a term beginning January 2027 (election, conference). A declaration on meaningful connectivity was adopted at the same conference; it is a regional commitment with no domestic implementing measure in this repository (declaration, connectivity). Holding the continental secretariat while the national artificial-intelligence strategy is undated and the data-protection regulator has no recorded action is the shape of this unit's international position. A delegation attended the UNDP Africa Accelerator for Digital Public Infrastructure session of 2-3 September 2026 alongside four other countries, on moving DPI blueprints to execution, verifiable credentials and consented data sharing, and reusable open-source deployment blueprints. No country programme, commitment or deliverable follows from it on the record. The country hosted the first Africa Digital Parliamentary Summit in July 2025, at which the Pan-African Parliament adopted the Lusaka Declaration on AI, data protection and privacy, committing members to digital literacy programmes for parliamentarians, Africa-led AI governance frameworks and health information exchange protocols. The declaration binds no state and no Zambian follow-up to it is held. The delegation completed a two-week learning mission to India, concluded 7 September 2026 (mission).	MOVEMENT

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Regional collaboration	**Regional legal harmonisation**	The continental convention on cyber security and personal data protection is signed, ratified and deposited. The African Union's own treaty status table records signature on 29 January 2016, ratification on 15 December 2020 and deposit on 24 March 2021 of the convention on cyber security and personal data protection. It is the clearest binding regional legal-harmonisation instrument the country has joined, and the repository holds nothing downstream of it: no domestic measure attributed to the convention, no report under it, and no regional body's assessment of Zambian compliance. Ratification is where this record stops.	NO CHANGE
Regional collaboration	**Shared regional infrastructure**	A regional programme steering committee convened in the capital, the programme's stated policy and oversight body held by a regional body rather than by member states. The third steering committee convened in July 2026, alongside the programme's annual digital forum (committee, forum, appraisal). Policy and oversight for a national digital programme sitting with a regional secretariat rather than with member states is a governance arrangement the record states and nowhere explains.	MOVEMENT
Regional collaboration	**Cross-border data transfers**	Zambia joined a five-country roadmap for customs-to-customs data exchange (roadmap). Zambia joined Malawi, Mozambique, South Africa and Zimbabwe in adopting a joint roadmap and action plan for customs-to-customs data exchange at a meeting in Pretoria on 24-26 August 2026 (roadmap). It is a roadmap, not a connection in service. The Data Protection Act, 2021 carries the cross-border data transfer regime at sections 70 and 71. That is the instrument. What the repository does not hold is any evidence of it operating: no adequacy determination for another country, no transfer authorisation granted, no condition imposed and no enforcement action. A transfer regime that has produced no visible decision in five years tells a reader about capacity rather than about policy — and the Commissioner's own account of registration as the outstanding first step is the corroboration.	MOVEMENT
Standards	**National interoperability standards**	Data interoperability standards are mandatory for every ministry, province and spending agency, with an annual compliance audit schedule. The state ICT institute issued public service ICT data interoperability standards that bind every ministry, province and spending agency, and carry an annual compliance audit schedule (standards). Together with the electronic government statute they set the data management and governance requirements for government data (scope). No audit finding, compliance rate or exemption is published, so whether the standards are met is not established - and officials pursuing the statute's amendment still name fragmented, vendor-locked systems as the problem. 2026-09-07 - the trust layer under those standards was stood up: the communications regulator operationalised the National Digital Trust Anchor as national root certification authority, the framework issuing and verifying certificates and signatures establishing the identity of people and organisations on the electronic communications and transactions statute. No certificate count, subordinate-authority list, accreditation route or fee schedule is published, and the launch reaches the repository through a news report rather than the regulator. The national public key infrastructure was launched with a named security vendor, its master cryptographic keys generated under independently audited conditions, held offline and split among multiple custodians so no single entity has unilateral control (launch).	NO CHANGE

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Standards	**National quality standards**	Quarterly network-performance reporting was announced, and a provincial minister names four districts where poor service blocks access to social cash transfers and farm input subsidies. Both regulator items behind the enforcement regime are paywalled ledes (reporting, disruption, action). Naming districts where poor service blocks social cash transfers and farm input subsidies makes quality of service a benefits-delivery question rather than a consumer one. Health ministry ICT standards issued in January 2014 are the oldest instrument in this ledger and the only national sectoral data standard the repository holds for the country (standards).	MOVEMENT
Standards	**Adoption of international standards**	The standards bureau states more than 50 international standards adopted within a catalogue of over 6,500, and an extractives validation scored 81 points. The standards bureau states that more than 50 international standards have been adopted as Zambian Standards, within a catalogue of more than 6,500 national standards across sectors including information and communication technology. The page is undated, so the figures are dated to retrieval. 2026-06-25 — the extractives transparency board found the country's fourth validation under the 2023 standard achieved a very good overall score of 81 points, an international standard applied and independently assessed here rather than merely adopted. Adoption counts and an assessed score are different kinds of evidence; the second is the rarer and it is not about digital.	MOVEMENT
Public debate and participation in policymaking	**Non-governmental contribution to national policy**	A constitutional consultation reported more than 11,864 public submissions, and a bill was deferred after civil-society concerns. A statute places non-state representation on national, provincial and district development coordinating committees and cluster advisory groups, and provides for state and non-state submission of budget policy proposals — participation as a standing statutory arrangement rather than an event. 2025-08 — the responsible minister deferred a bill on non-governmental organisations after civil-society and non-governmental stakeholders raised concerns, an explicit government response to non-state input. 2025-11-25 — a nationwide constitutional consultation reporting more than 11,864 public submissions through public sittings, submission boxes, website and email was handed to the President. It is the largest documented consultation on this ledger and its subject is the constitution rather than digital policy.	MOVEMENT

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Public debate and participation in policymaking	**Open discussion of government policy**	Observer missions issued preliminary statements on digital systems in the 2026 general election, and a consent judgment requires a reason for any internet interruption within 36 hours. Two independent accounts of the August election period were published: one on the reach and risks of digital campaigning (account), and one recording that no internet shutdown was imposed and asking why (account). The consent judgment was entered after election-period blocking in August 2021 and requires a reason for any interruption within 36 hours; it is known to the repository only through a coalition letter (judgment). The Human Rights Commission considered 105 alleged violations and resolved 62; the listed remedies are administrative rather than adjudicative, and no sanction, compensation or determination is reported (cases). 2026-09-11 to 15 - a magistrate convicted a vlogger under section 54 of the 2021 cyber Act for forwarding a WhatsApp screenshot to a group and sentenced him to nine months; a tailor was arrested under the same Act over a TikTok video about the president. 2026-09-19 - a third arrest inside ten days, the first laid by a private party: police in Ndola arrested a TikToker over videos about truck drivers, on a complaint by a trustee of a drivers' association. The charge and statute are unestablished - the account is a membership-walled lede.	MOVEMENT

Finance

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure	**Sustainable domestic financing of digital transformation**	The 2026 Appropriation Act gives the technology ministry's ICT development programme K566.8m and the state ICT institute's e-government programme K1.15bn, both enacted in December 2025. Appropriation Act No. 28 of 2025 was assented on 23 December 2025, carrying K566.8m for ICT development and K1.15bn for Smart Zambia e-government in 2026 (act). For 2025 the institute had K452.1m (act), and a supplementary appropriation in August 2025 added K194.3m for ICT development (supplementary). Approved is the source's word, and whether this is a cabinet approval, an appropriation or an in-year release is not stated; the amount is carried in local currency only and no funding source is named (allocation, record). No counterpart line against the acceleration project grant is identified in the appropriations.	MOVEMENT
Financial sustainability	**Financial sustainability of digital systems**		NO EVIDENCE
MoUs and other agreements	**Strategic relationships**	Four memoranda were signed — digital identity with a neighbour, a government compact with the payments association, a bilateral between two external organisations, and a card partnership — and none publishes a value. The identity memorandum was reported signed with the signing date not established, and no value, duration or workplan is stated (identity). The payments compact followed a State House meeting with no document, value or target published (compact). The third is a bilateral between two external organisations coordinating their support to government, with no value, duration or termination terms disclosed and the text unpublished (coordination, rollout); the card partnership reports no value, volume commitment or launch product (card).	MOVEMENT

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New investments	**Mobilisation of non-state finance**	A digital lender announced a K500m expansion on its tenth anniversary, a forward intention by the lender itself with no external financier or named recipient. The announcement was made in July 2026 (lending). Development-finance equity in the independent tower portfolio exited in March 2021 and a US$75m loan was fully disbursed from that year (towers); the over-1,700 tower figure is the financiers' own and is not dated more precisely than 2021 (towers, loan). Two private-capital records, one an intention and one five years old, is the whole of non-state finance here.	MOVEMENT
New investments	**Development-partner project financing**	A digital acceleration project was board-approved in September 2025 as the fifth operation of a multiphase regional programme, with expected disbursement of US$6 million in the lender's 2026 financial year. The programme envelope is US$2.48bn across fifteen countries (project, appraisal, rollout). A rural connectivity project has a stated closing date of December 2025; its implementing agency is a road fund agency, which does not sit easily with the broadband description, and it should be treated as suspect before use as evidence of digital financing (rural). A regional science and technology accelerator is at expressions-of-interest stage: the fund is resourced, the delivery consortium is not chosen, and no national allocation is stated (accelerator). Statistics carries its own donor line: Sweden committed a second phase of grants to the statistics agency in July 2025, implemented with Statistics Sweden to 2029 and covering a yearly household budget survey, after a 2019-2023 phase that has closed. 2026-10-01 - the regional programme's half-year report records a second early market engagement on 22 April 2026 for 300 towers and 2,000 km of fibre.	MOVEMENT

ICT Infrastructure

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Connectivity	**Mobile penetration**	The technology ministry puts the country at about 26.2 million mobile subscriptions in 2025 against 23.2 million in 2024. The technology ministry put the country at about 26.2 million mobile subscriptions in 2025, up from 23.2 million in 2024, with about 14.7 million of them mobile internet (ministry). These are the ministry's own figures, given in a seminar address rather than a regulator publication. 2026-09-03 - a second account of the same period puts internet subscriptions at 14.7m in 2025 against 10.4m in 2021 and mobile population coverage at 95% over 2022 to 2025, alongside the services the national portal carries. The coverage figure is government-reported and does not reconcile with the ministry's own separate claim for the same period. 2025-05 - a regional operator's group results name Zambia among five markets sharing close to 1,500 5G sites; no national 5G site, coverage or subscriber figure is held. 2026-09-18 - the technology ministry gave a 2021-2025 series: mobile subscriptions from about 20.2 million to more than 26 million, internet subscriptions from 10.4 to 14.68 million, penetration from 56.7 to 72.1 per cent and fibre from about 15,000 to more than 42,000 kilometres.	MOVEMENT

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Connectivity	**Internet usage**	Internet adoption has been flat across two annual readings, and mobile connections count connections rather than people. The adoption reading is cited rather than absorbed, and has been flat across two annual compilations (users, prior). Mobile connections are connections, not people, and the regulator's separate administrative series counts subscriptions per hundred inhabitants (connections). A median fixed broadband download reading is likewise cited and not absorbed (speed). Every usage figure in this unit comes from a foreign compiler rather than the national regulator.	NO CHANGE
Connectivity	**Mobile affordability**	The regulator's 2025 sector report carries its own subscription and affordability figures, and the mobile money levy schedule was revised. An external country diagnostic published Zambia-specific prepaid one-gigabyte and voice basket prices — the repository's earlier affordability position, from a foreign tool rather than a domestic series. 2026-03 — the regulator's 2025 ICT and postal sector market performance report gave its own current mobile subscription and affordability figures, which is the more durable source. 2025-12-30 — an Act revised the person-to-person mobile money transfer levy schedule, effective 1 January 2026. A transfer levy is an affordability question for the poorest users of the payment system, and no assessment of its incidence accompanies it. 2026-09-16 — one operator cut its entry home fibre price to K300 a month for 6 Mbps.	MOVEMENT
Connectivity	**National fibre backbone**	The backbone extension financing stood at 0 per cent disbursement as of July 2022 — the largest single undrawn digital-infrastructure commitment the repository holds — and the two national fibre-length figures are irreconcilable. Corruption allegations from a former utility board chairman are on the record against the undrawn commitment (extension). Neither fibre-length figure states whether it counts backbone only or backbone plus metropolitan and access network, which is why they cannot be reconciled (length, appraisal). A second communication towers programme reached 87.8 per cent disbursement on ministry reporting through a third-party database (towers). One programme nearly drawn and one not drawn at all, both Chinese-financed, is the backbone record. A mobile operator is buying about 1,300 km of fibre for K324.9m from a related company, a transfer inside one group rather than new network.	MIXED a backbone extension financed and 0 per cent drawn while the two national fibre-length figures cannot be reconciled
Connectivity	**International internet bandwidth**	A cross-border fibre interconnector was commissioned in February 2026 with no capacity, cost or funder stated, and a terrestrial cable segment is stated ready for service in 2027. The interconnector was commissioned in February 2026 (interconnector, appraisal). The cable segment's 2027 date was first stated inside the window; the position itself did not move (segment, investment). For a landlocked country these two routes are the whole of the international capacity record, and neither carries a capacity figure.	MOVEMENT

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Connectivity	**Internet Exchange Points**	The Lusaka exchange carries 12 peers on 76G, and a regional DNS deployment went live on it. The exchange's peering record lists 12 peers over 12 connections, 10 of them open, on 76G of total capacity with full support for the newer addressing protocol. 2025-12 — a regional internet registry's DNS deployment went live at the exchange, its own account putting the reduction in query latency at roughly 93 per cent. Local DNS resolution is the least visible and most consequential thing an exchange does: it keeps lookups from crossing an ocean before a page begins to load, and the figure is the deploying body's own rather than an independent measurement. Traffic statistics for the exchange itself remain linked rather than published.	MOVEMENT
Connectivity	**Satellite broadband licensing and availability**	The country is among the top three African satellite markets by June 2026 after entry in October 2023, and no national subscriber count, licence fee, contract term or procurement route is held. Market entry was October 2023 and the country ranks among the top three African markets by June 2026 (market, appraisal, chiefdom, skills). A top-three continental position with no licence fee, contract term or procurement route on record is worth stating as exactly that. Direct-to-cell satellite trials name the country as a trial site on an operator statement, with no licence, spectrum decision or trial result held (trials).	MOVEMENT
Data Storage	**Local data centre capacity (all providers)**	A memorandum on a national artificial-intelligence data centre was signed with the vendor that built the existing national data centre a decade earlier. The memorandum is not a contract, and the same vendor built the existing national facility (memorandum, centre). The existing facility's phase one commenced in January 2016 under a Chinese concessional loan, and it is the only state data-centre facility the repository describes in physical terms (centre). An edge data centre plan names the country among target countries on a company statement of intent rather than a commitment (edge). The commercial market can now be sized, and it is very small: about five live facilities carrying roughly 2MW of live critical IT load at about 60 per cent occupancy, on roughly $5 million of annual revenue, with nothing under construction and a further 2MW or so in long-term pipeline. Critical IT load per million people lags Botswana, Kenya, Côte d'Ivoire and Ethiopia, and the estimate is an analyst's rather than an operator or regulator disclosure. 2021-10-01 - a 1 MW carrier-neutral facility opened in Lusaka on about K140m (US$5.75m), after a Covid delay. In March 2023 the government signed a memorandum for another operator to build a commercial data centre and supply cloud services to the state, with no amount, site or date given; nothing after it is held.	MOVEMENT
Data Storage	**Local data centre capacity (national providers)**	A memorandum to co-invest in a national artificial-intelligence data centre, and a national operator partnering on next-generation cloud. A parliamentary committee report on ICT infrastructure is the repository's standing account of national data-centre capacity. 2026-05-26 — the state technology institute and a vendor signed a memorandum to co-invest in a national artificial-intelligence data centre, announced at a mobile congress. 2026-07 — a national operator partnered with a cloud provider to deliver next-generation cloud services. Two commitments and no capacity figure: neither states megawatts, racks, tier or a commissioning date, so the repository can record that capacity is being contracted for and not how much.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data Storage	**Off-site backup capacity**	A procurement notice for servers and a backup platform and a national operator cloud partnership, over a committee finding on disaster-recovery sites. A parliamentary committee review of the state technology institute carries the repository's finding on disaster-recovery sites, alongside the government wide area network rollout. 2025-08 — a national coordinating office issued a procurement notice for servers and an open network automation platform backup solution. 2026-07 — a national operator partnered to deliver cloud services that would carry backup capacity commercially. One agency's procurement and one commercial partnership is what the window holds. No government-wide backup policy, recovery-point objective or tested restoration is on the record.	MOVEMENT
Energy	**Sufficient energy and water for data centres**	Construction launched on a 250MW solar plant with 600MWh of storage, and a 500MW solar power purchase agreement was signed. A parliamentary committee report on ICT infrastructure sets out the energy constraint on data centres — the repository's standing position on the supply side. 2026-04-21 — construction was launched on a 250MW solar plant with 150MW and 600MWh of battery storage, aimed at stabilising national supply. 2026-06 — the national utility signed a 500MW solar power purchase agreement with battery storage. Both are generation rather than a data-centre power arrangement, and neither states a connection date or a firm capacity for digital load. Nothing at all in the repository addresses water for cooling.	MOVEMENT
Energy	**Grid reliability**	The tower company invested US$5m in power resilience at mobile sites (report). The load-shedding statement comes from a lender appraisal; an eased-hours figure circulating elsewhere has no source in this repository and is not carried (load-shedding). Solar power was stated complete for all 116 councils at a state institute briefing, with no capacity, cost, supplier or verification held (solar). Powering every council office while the grid constrains digital services generally is a sensible sequence, and the completion claim is the government's own. About 650 priority health facilities carry solar power financed by an international health fund and a further 1,050 carry solar back-up power, on a base whose national electrification rate was about 44.5 per cent in 2023 and whose installed generation capacity is about 83 per cent hydroelectric (case study). The same account puts internet connectivity in 883 health facilities (case study). A hydro-dominated grid in a country that has been load-shedding is the reason the backup is being financed facility by facility, and the financing partner rather than the utility is the one reporting it.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Energy	**Rural electrification**	A grid project brought power for the first time to a catchment of 42,000, and a US$200 million access programme launched. The Rural Electrification Act, 2023 continues the rural electrification authority and its fund, repealing the 2003 Act. 2025-08 — the authority completed a grid development project in Western Province, bringing grid power for the first time to a catchment population of 42,000. A named completed connection with a population behind it is the rarest form of evidence on this indicator. 2025-12 — a US$200 million programme was launched targeting universal electricity access by 2030. The gap between one district connected and universal access by 2030 is the whole of what this row cannot yet measure: no national access rate or connection series is held.	MOVEMENT
Technical Capacity	**Robustness of government hardware and software**	The government wide area network declared phase one complete in March 2026 and had border-post gaps confirmed in August, and connected has at times meant completed site works rather than live service. A primary of February 2025 establishes that connected has at times meant completed site works rather than live end-to-end service, which is the qualification every connection count in this unit needs (network, deployment, councils, expansion). A border-post connectivity upgrade across five trade corridors set a national standard and commissioned an independent audit; the audit precedes the procurement rather than following it (border). Commissioning the audit before the procurement is the right order and is unusual in this frame. 2026-08-31 — a further Northern Province district administration was connected and its staff oriented on the national portal and office collaboration tools, after which an official printed a road-tax document in his own office rather than travelling to the provincial centre. It is the clearest published instance of a connection reaching a transaction, and it is one office: no district count, schedule or cost for the programme is published. The Auditor-General's audit of the 2024 accounts found the financial management system running without system logs or offsite backup (audit).	MOVEMENT
Technical Capacity	**Local capacity to maintain, manage and develop government systems**	A smart office management system demonstrated in June 2025 has not moved — the clearest pre-window baseline in this ledger that has not — and a property management system launched in May 2026. The office system was demonstrated at health ministry headquarters with one province selected as pilot, and has not moved since (office). The property management system was launched by the infrastructure ministry with the state ICT institute (property). A digital loan system for civil servants was briefed to the microfinance association at a courtesy call, with no agreement or memorandum reported (loans).	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Cybersecurity	**National cybersecurity readiness**	The cyber security agency moved to new premises and issued a post-election warning, and 43,500 subscriber cards were deactivated for mobile-money fraud in six months. The drug enforcement commission reported the arrest of 79 cybercrime suspects over a digital laboratory it says targeted government systems (report), and the cyber security agency issued a public advisory on rising online disinformation after the electoral period (advisory). The agency's director general accounts for the move by saying it had been housed in the state institute's offices where space limited staff accommodation and key functions, and that the new premises let the whole team work together with access to its tools — which dates the constraint rather than measuring what it cost. No incident-response capability, staffing figure or service level is published before or after (warning, offices, trafficking). The card deactivations cover January to June 2026 and are held as a paywalled lede (deactivations). A company survey reports consumers targeted by digital fraud, with the comparison base shifted from one quarter's fieldwork window to another's (fraud).	MOVEMENT

DPI

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data Exchange	**National data exchange system**	The government service bus onboarded eight local authorities from June 2026, and a named data-exchange layer is not the component through which the evidenced exchange work runs. Eight local authorities were onboarded from June 2026, and no held source states how a separately named government bus relates to the service bus or to the national portal (bus, statement, finances). A data-exchange layer is named in the acceleration project appraisal as a complementary platform for data integration and exchange; the exchange work that is actually evidenced runs through the service bus, not through a component of that name (layer, appraisal). Distinguishing the named component from the working one is what stops a project document being read as delivery. The bus has a published service count behind it: 290 services were deployed on it by July 2024, alongside a citizens support portal, a public service portal and an electronic know-your-customer system. Driving licence, road tax and vehicle registration applications run through the citizen-facing portal it sits under, where the queues that remain are for collecting licences that have not been printed. No exchange volume across the bus is published. 2026-10-01 - bids for the service bus's redesign were evaluated and under the lender's review at June 2026.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data Exchange	**Use of digital id in other systems**	An input voucher ran electronic know-your-customer across all 116 districts, removing 225,016 ineligible beneficiaries. The Electronic Government Act, 2021 requires public bodies to offer electronic proof of identity issued under the National Registration Act and to enable joint automated procedures and data sharing between public bodies — the legal basis. 2026-01 — the farmer input support voucher reached all 116 districts using electronic know-your-customer verification cross-checked against the pension authority and other registers, removing 212,851 and then a further 12,165 ineligible beneficiaries. That is identity being queried against other registers across the whole country, which is what this indicator asks and what most of the continent cannot show. 2025-09-29 — a digital identity cooperation agreement with Ethiopia was formalised, use-case driven and explicitly linking identity verification to civil registration, social protection and mobile money.	MOVEMENT
Data Exchange	**Interoperability of health systems**	The health ministry published a national HL7 FHIR implementation guide defining profiles across five named systems. The health ministry published its own national HL7 FHIR R5 interoperability specification, defining reusable profiles for exchanging data among the clinical system, the health management information system, the master facility list, the electronic logistics system and the human resources information system, superseding the earlier strategy's draft framework. A published implementation guide naming the systems it connects is a stronger artefact than an interoperability policy, and it is unusual: most of the continent's health interoperability positions on this frame are workshops. What is not yet held is any statement of conformance — no system is recorded as implementing the guide.	MOVEMENT
Data Exchange	**Interoperability of education systems**	Higher education institutions were directed to submit student data for a centralised database with institution-independent index numbers. A mid-term review records education management information system reform under way with a teacher database review under consideration. 2026-03 — the higher education authority directed all institutions to submit student data for a centralised national student database with institution-independent index numbers, under the 2021 amendment Act. No linkage to the national identity or civil registration registers is stated, which is the connection that would make the index durable. 2026-06-12 — a sector-wide education and skills data challenge and its technical working group were launched, the leading sector data-governance development in the window.	MOVEMENT
Data Exchange	**Interoperability of social protection systems**	A workshop brought five agencies and line ministries together and produced a draft roadmap and technical committee. 2025-09 — a US$100 million digital acceleration programme was approved, its interoperable and secure platforms pillar funding digital government services and data exchange. 2025-09-14 to 21 — a workshop in Kitwe brought the pension authority, the health insurance authority, the workers' compensation board, the disability agency, the state technology institute and line ministries together, producing a draft convergence roadmap and a technical committee to link the social protection systems. Naming the five bodies that have to connect is the useful part. A roadmap and a committee are not an exchange: no interface, data-sharing agreement or go-live date follows from either in the record.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Identity and CRVS	**Robustness of system**	The integrated registration information system reports end-to-end automation of birth and death notification under way, and the three enrolment figures held do not reconcile — a later source carrying a lower figure than an earlier one with no revision reported. A later source carrying a lower figure than an earlier one, with no revision reported by any party, is the reconciliation problem stated plainly (system, safeguards, enrolment). Procurement of an international system integrator for an open-standards identity build opened in March 2026; the card is to carry registration-card functions plus travel and private-sector service access, and delivery dates diverge between the state ICT institute and the Registrar General (procurement, training, advance). Two agencies giving different delivery dates for one credential is worth recording as the coordination question it is. 2026-09-19 - national identity documents have been invalidated for people the government accuses of campaigning to discredit it abroad, confirmed not by any official announcement but by a former deputy minister of home affairs defending the measure. How many are affected and under what legal process is unstated: no statute, notice or appeal route is given, and no government statement is on file. 2026-10-01 - re-evaluation of the bids to deploy and integrate the identity and civil registration modules was complete at June 2026, awaiting the lender's review.	NO CHANGE
Digital Identity and CRVS	**Registration of entire population**	Biometric enrolment runs against a funded baseline of 1,500,000 people with digitally verifiable identity at December 2022 and a 4,000,000 target at October 2030, and card issuance was deferred until after the August 2026 election. The enrolment figure was given by the ministry to the state broadcaster (enrolment, safeguards, switch). Biometric card issuance was deferred to after the general election (deferral). A nationwide mobile campaign for 3.5m identity documents launched for a three-month run in April 2025, and its result is the largest single unreported outcome in the pre-window base (campaign). The paper card has been in issue since before independence, on the appraisal document's own wording rather than a published commencement date (paper card).	MIXED biometric enrolment progressing against a 2030 target while card issuance was deferred past the election
Digital Identity and CRVS	**National maintenance of id and credentials systems**	The registration department began computerising card, passport and citizenship-document issuance, financed through a US$100 million programme. 2025-08 — the home affairs permanent secretary announced that the registration department has begun computerising national registration card, passport and citizenship-document issuance in collaboration with the state technology institute, targeting online applications including from the diaspora. 2025-09 — a US$100 million digital acceleration programme was approved, the financing vehicle for the new identity and civil registration system. What the repository cannot yet say is who will run it. Both accounts describe a build financed externally and integrated by a vendor to be selected; no statement of in-house operating capacity, staffing or vendor exit arrangement is held.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Identity and CRVS	**Authentication**	A national authentication service runs single sign-on, OpenID Connect, multi-factor and passwordless credentials for e-government. The state technology institute publishes the service description of the national authentication and access-control service: single sign-on, OpenID Connect, multi-factor authentication and passwordless credentials for electronic government services. An operating authentication service with named protocols is the strongest identity artefact on this ledger, and it is what makes the downstream uses recorded elsewhere possible. The page is undated, so the position is dated to retrieval, and no user count, uptime figure or list of relying services is published — so the repository can describe the service and not its reach.	MOVEMENT
Digital Identity and CRVS	**Digital id from birth**	Civil registration funding was raised 67 per cent after advocacy, against only 22 per cent of under-fives with registered births. The Births and Deaths Registration Act of 1973 requires uniform registration of every birth and death, the statutory root from which a birth-time identity number would derive. 2026-05 — advocacy reversed a proposed cut and secured a 67 per cent funding increase for civil registration in the 2026 budget, and helped establish a 26-member parliamentary caucus in October 2025, explicitly framed as the foundation the digital identity reform needs, since only 22 per cent of under-fives have registered births and 15 per cent in rural areas. Those two percentages are the finding. An identity number issued at birth reaches roughly a fifth of children, and a budget increase is the first movement toward changing that.	MOVEMENT
Digital Identity and CRVS	**Interoperability of birth registration and digital id**	A system integrator was invited to deploy and integrate foundational identity and civil registration modules, over a regulation deriving the card number from the birth record. Regulation 6(2)(a) of the National Registration Regulations, 2019 is the clearest legal linkage: for a person born in Zambia the national registration card number is derived from that person's birth-registration record. The link exists in law. 2025-09 — the acceleration project invited vendors for a system integrator to deploy, customise and integrate foundational digital identity and civil registration core modules, including data migration and enrolment kits — the procurement that would make the legal link technical. 2026-04 — the country's civil registration experience informed validation of a continental interoperability framework's non-functional requirements; it is not among the six pilot countries.	MOVEMENT
Digital Identity and CRVS	**Use by other systems**	Passport and travel-document applications now require a national authentication account on the government service bus. The Electronic Government Act, 2021 creates a citizen card as the cross-system identity and authentication credential. 2025-12 — the home affairs minister announced that passport, diplomatic passport, refugee travel document and identity travel document applications are integrated into the government service bus and require a national authentication account — the clearest live downstream use of the authentication service by another government system. 2026-01 — an agricultural input voucher ran electronic know-your-customer across all 116 districts, the largest-scale consumption of identity the repository holds for the country.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Payments and Fintech	**Governance role of central bank**	The national financial switch has its cost-reduction objective stated on record as not yet delivered, and cheque acceptance is to stop on a date sourced from a single sentence about another country. The electronic clearing house is stated as not yet live on the regional instant-payment scheme, and central bank interest in the continental system is characterised as conversation rather than commitment (switch). The cheque stop date comes from a single sentence in an article about another country, and no central bank circular is held (cheques, comparator). Ending an instrument on a date evidenced only in foreign coverage is a limit on what this report can state about the transition.	MOVEMENT
Digital Payments and Fintech	**G2P functionality**	The social cash transfer began its July-August 2026 cycle disbursement, on the ministry's own figures with no redemption rate, provider list or exclusion figure published. The cycle disbursement began in August 2026 (disbursement). A provincial minister separately names four districts where poor network service blocks access to social cash transfers and farm input subsidies, so the exclusion figure nobody publishes is the one that would measure whether the transfer arrives.	MOVEMENT
Digital Payments and Fintech	**Revenue collection**	The government payment gateway puts cumulative collections at over K8.8 billion with no stated start date, and the two digital revenue figures cover different periods and issuers. The collection total has no stated start date, so it is a cumulative figure of unknown period (gateway, appraisal, property). The two revenue figures cover different periods and issuers and are not a like-for-like series (revenue, investment, finances). A cumulative total of unknown period and two non-comparable figures are what the revenue record supports. 2026-09-30 - the 2027-2029 budget call circular names the service bus and payment gateway as the centralised revenue-collection system.	MOVEMENT
Digital Payments and Fintech	**B2B and B2G functionality**	A 2025 Act mandates an electronic single window and single payment point for trade duties; a new payment Act is passed but not commenced. 2025-08 — the border management and trade facilitation statute mandates an electronic single window and a single payment point platform for import, export and transit duties, taxes, fees and levies — a direct business-to-government payment integration for traders. 2026-04-08 — a new National Payment System Act replaces the 2007 statute, creating licensing and market-conduct rules for payment service providers covering these rails. It is not yet commenced, which is the operative fact: the regime that would govern these payments is enacted and not in force. No transaction volume or value on either rail is published.	MOVEMENT
Digital Payments and Fintech	**P2P, P2G and P2B functionality**	Mobile wallets reached a bank's point-of-sale terminals and cash machines, and councils were onboarded for electronic fee payment. The National Payment Systems Act of 2007 established regulatory authority over the payment mechanisms underlying these rails. 2026-03 — a mobile money wallet gained interoperability with a commercial bank's point-of-sale terminals and cash machines, a concrete person-to-business and cash-out expansion. 2026-07 — local authorities including one municipal council were onboarded to the government service bus, enabling electronic payment of council fees and levies. Person-to-government payment reaching local rather than central government is the newer half, and no count of councils, transactions or value is published against it. 2026-10-05 - the operator launched a self-care application and a short-code digital financial service; no user figure is published.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Payments and Fintech	**Population uptake**	Financial inclusion among adults rose on a national consumer survey published by the central bank, with the survey month not stated, and securities exchange app users rose on the exchange's own registration figure. The inclusion figure is carried at year precision because the survey month is not stated (inclusion). The exchange figure is for registered users, not active traders or funded accounts (app users). Registered rather than active, and a survey with no stated month, are the two qualifications every uptake claim in this unit carries. 2026-09-05 - the account base behind the inclusion figure was stated: 14.7m registered mobile money accounts in 2024 on the monetary fund's financial access survey, of which 77% hold a balance, against a central bank phasing out cheque clearing and one adult in five holding any account in 2011. Registered accounts are not people, and the balance share is the only measure of activity held.	MOVEMENT
Digital Payments and Fintech	**Cross-border functionality**	A regional retail payments platform published its scheme rulebook and a gender strategy, and currency onboarding to the regional settlement system is attributed to the system's operator rather than the national central bank. The corridor with a neighbour is the one the platform runs on; no national transaction volume, participant count or fee schedule is published (platform). The currency onboarding is a statement of intent attributed to the system's operator, not to the national central bank (onboarding, switch). Card acceptance was extended to nine African markets with merchant and card counts given as the two companies' own and no country-specific figure (cards). A commercial bank launched direct renminbi settlement for trade with China over China's cross-border interbank system on 23 September 2026, with the commerce ministry backing it and no volume or fee published (launch).	MOVEMENT
Digital Payments and Fintech	**Consumer protection**	The 2026 payment Act carries a dedicated consumer-protection regime, over a 2018 directive prohibiting 26 categories of charge. A central bank directive prohibits 26 categories of unwarranted charges and fees on financial services — the clearest standalone consumer-protection instrument for digital and card payments, and eight years old. 2026-03 — the central bank's journal carried a notice on registration of virtual asset service providers, moving crypto activity toward supervised status. 2026-04-08 — the new payment system Act carries a dedicated consumer-protection regime alongside market-conduct rules for payment service providers. It is not yet commenced. No complaint volume, redress statistic or enforcement action under the 2018 directive is held, so what protection currently delivers cannot be read.	MOVEMENT
Registries	**Population register**	A sample based registration system was launched to capture deaths occurring outside health facilities. 2026-05 — the health ministry launched a sample based registration system with vital statistics, extending continuous civil-registration coverage to deaths outside health facilities — what the reporting describes as the silent deaths the register was missing. Deaths outside facilities are the harder half of civil registration everywhere, and a sample-based system is an acknowledgement that universal capture is not close. No coverage estimate, sample size or first result is published, and the repository holds no statement of the population register's own completeness to read it against.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Registries	**Civil register**	The birth registration rate is an external agency figure cited by the Registrar General, so a 50 per cent target for end-2026 has no measured mid-point on file. The rate is cited rather than measured domestically (rate, target). Civil registration runs on a three-pillar strategy stated at a continental civil registration day (registration), and a modernisation programme was launched on the same three pillars (programme). A target with no measured mid-point, four months from its date, is the position.	NO CHANGE
Registries	**Address register**	A national spatial data infrastructure policy and geoportal launched, over a 2017 regulation assigning the postcode and address database. A 2017 regulation under the postal services statute assigns the communications authority responsibility to regulate, allocate and manage postcodes and to maintain a national address database, and sets the technical postcode model. The legal duty has existed for nine years. 2026-06-16 — a national spatial data infrastructure policy and a national geoportal were launched, which government describes as ending fragmentation of address and geospatial data across agencies. A geoportal is not an address register, and the record does not say whether the postcode database the 2017 regulation requires was ever built — which is the question the launch implicitly answers by describing fragmentation.	MOVEMENT
Registries	**Business register**	9,163 companies were registered between January and May 2026, and a project began rebuilding the register in house. The registration agency reported 9,163 companies incorporated between January and May 2026, against 8,551 in the same months of 2025, a rise of 7 per cent. 2025-12-30 — an amendment Act strengthened beneficial-ownership disclosure, verification and periodic review obligations on the register of companies and the register of beneficial owners. 2026-03 — a multi-year project was launched with the registration agency and a donor funder to build a next-generation, in-house business and beneficial ownership registration system. In-house is the operative word: a register rebuilt by its own agency rather than licensed from a vendor is a different long-run proposition, and no cost, timetable or go-live date is published for it.	MOVEMENT
Registries	**Social protection register**	The social cash transfer reached 1,555,840 households in February 2026, up from 1.3 million, after 305,000 were added against a plan for 250,000. The ministry reported the nationwide scale-up complete in February 2026, taking coverage from 1.3 million to 1,555,840 households. More than 300,000 households were added where 250,000 had been planned for 2025, which the minister attributed to the reach of the sensitisation campaign and to demand. The count is the ministry's own, given at a press briefing, with no independent verification held, and it sits against a unified national social registry approved by cabinet in April 2025 that is still in early implementation.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Registries	**Electoral register**	The final register was certified at 8,786,300 voters with polling-station detail across 13,529 stations, after 1,615,922 were added. 2026-03-06 — a ministerial statement reported a 48-day mass registration exercise that added 1,615,922 new voters, bringing the provisional register to 8,861,918, followed by inspection and biometric verification. 2026-05-02 — the commission announced certification of the register for the general election on 4 May. 2026-05-08 — the final register was published at 8,786,300 registered voters with polling-station-level detail across 13,529 polling stations. The difference between the provisional register and the certified one is what inspection and biometric verification removed, and neither account explains it — which for an electoral register is the thing a reader most wants explained.	MOVEMENT
Registries	**Tax register**	Register holders rose to 6,571,699 while active tax accounts rose only from 379,985 to 388,779. A 2023 amendment made obtaining a taxpayer identification number a statutory obligation, effective 1 January 2024. 2026-07 — the revenue authority's annual report shows register holders growing from 6,015,533 in 2024 to 6,571,699 in 2025, while active tax accounts rose only from 379,985 to 388,779. Six per cent of the register is active. A statutory registration obligation produces a register, and this is what a register produced that way looks like. 2025-10 — an amendment bill enabling information exchange among revenue authority divisions and with the entities it establishes was tabled, commencing 1 January 2026, which is the reform aimed at the gap.	MIXED the register grew while active accounts barely moved
Registries	**Land register**	The integrated land administration system went live in May 2023, and the minister told Parliament the predecessor ran with no maintenance contract from March 2022, creating a conduit for corruption. The system went live after data migration from the predecessor (system, clearance, gateway, expansion). The minister's statement that the predecessor ran unmaintained for over a year, creating a conduit for corruption, is a government account of its own prior failure and is the most specific such statement in this ledger. The denominator is now on record and it is the finding: fewer than 450,000 of an estimated 1.2 million numbered properties hold registered title deeds, and about 45,000 owners pay ground rent, yielding roughly K157 million a year against more than K1.2 billion if compliance improved. That 1.2 million excludes customary land entirely, so the untitled share of the country is larger than the ratio suggests.	NO CHANGE
Sectoral management information systems	**Health**	A national electronic health record is deployed at about 80 per cent of health facilities, and the identity-integration account is implementer-authored and promotional with no independent evaluation held. The deployment share was reported in July 2026 (record, presentation, expansion, rural). A hospital edition pilot launched at a teaching hospital, and whether it shares the national record's fingerprint enrolment or the open-standards identifier is not established (pilot). An emergency outbreak response platform is in two-day user-acceptance testing rather than in service, with no go-live date, hosting arrangement or data-governance rule published (outbreak). Eighty per cent facility coverage is among the highest in this frame, and the evaluation behind it is the implementer's. 2025-01-01 - a country analysis found 99% of expected monthly facility reports in DHIS2 in 2024, against 93% in 2019.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Sectoral management information systems	**Education**	The education management information system was built in one district, replacing annual school returns keyed into a desktop database. An implementing partner, working with the education ministry and a UN agency, built the system on the open-source platform already used for the national water and sanitation programme, from 2016 and in one district (system). Before it, the ministry depended on annual reports from schools entered into a desktop database, which meant attendance and termly standardised exam scores were never captured at all (before). Nothing on record states that the district implementation has been extended nationally, and no enrolment, attendance or school coverage figure from the system is published. 2026-09-24 - beneficiary verification for the Keeping Girls in School programme moved from paper forms to a tablet application on which each girl is captured and signs for herself, on one district's account.	NO CHANGE
Sectoral management information systems	**Social protection**	A national social registry is Cabinet-approved and still under design, while the ministry launched a digital strategy and continuity guidelines. A project appraisal gives the fullest account of the beneficiary system's architecture, coverage and function — the operational system carrying the social cash transfer. 2025-11 — a project paper records the current standing: the beneficiary system operational, and a dynamic national social registry approved by Cabinet in April 2025 with its concept note endorsed in September, still under design. 2025-11-13 — the responsible ministry launched a ministerial digital strategy, business continuity and disaster recovery guidelines and ICT security guidelines underpinning the existing system and its planned registry expansion. Continuity guidelines before a registry is built is the right order and an unusual one.	MOVEMENT
Sectoral management information systems	**Justice**	A contract tracking and management system was launched with the justice ministry, held as a paywalled lede with no volume or turnaround figure published. It was launched in July 2026 (system). It is the only justice-sector system in this ledger, and what it does is known only from a headline.	MOVEMENT
Sectoral management information systems	**Tax**	Electronic invoicing moved into court enforcement: seven taxpayers prosecuted against more than 44,000 businesses registered. A 2023 amendment defined the electronic invoicing system in law, effective 1 January 2024. 2025-08 — a sectoral mandate onboarded 494 filling stations, 59 of them by direct system integration — integration rather than issuance being the harder half. 2026-05-11 — the revenue authority moved non-compliance into court against seven taxpayers, with more than 44,000 businesses registered. A system passes from onboarding into enforcement exactly once, and this is that point; seven prosecutions against a register of that size is a signal rather than a campaign, and no compliance rate is published to read it against.	MOVEMENT
Sectoral management information systems	**Customs**	A memorandum on border post scanning and security technology was signed in August 2026, with no commitment amount, equipment specification or delivery timetable stated. It was signed on 24 August 2026 (memorandum). It sits alongside the border-post connectivity upgrade recorded separately, and no source relates the two — scanning equipment and the network it would report over, procured on different tracks.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Sectoral management information systems	**Land**	The land system's electronic services were temporarily disrupted, explained to Parliament in a ministerial statement. A ministerial statement to the National Assembly addressed a temporary disruption of the ministry's electronic services on the government service bus through the land administration system. That is the repository's only record of the country's land administration system, and it is an outage rather than a description. No coverage figure, parcel count, restoration date or account of what the system does is held — so what can be stated is that a land information system exists, is connected to the government service bus, and stopped working for long enough to require a statement to Parliament.	NO CHANGE one outage and no description of the system
Other GovTech and e-Gov	**e-government services**	The national portal reports over 400 services onboarded — a figure stated for the service bus, gateway, portal and payment platform together rather than the portal alone — and an electronic government amendment bill is in development. 2026-09-05 - the office system moved beyond ministries: the airports corporation became the first state-owned enterprise onboarded, with 406 staff to be trained by the end of November. 2025-12-17 - the World Bank's 2025 GovTech Maturity Index placed the country in Group B, significant maturity, the group it held on the 2022 edition. 2026-09-14 — procurement moved online in volume: 103,326 tenders were published through the electronic system in 2025, more than twice the 45,724 of 2024. Tenders published, not contracts awarded. 2026-09-24 - the public service management division said a digital platform for the public service funeral scheme, letting members register beneficiaries and track claims online, would roll out in the first week of October. 2026-09-25 - the information ministry launched an in-house media monitoring and reporting system that also tracks the presidential delivery priorities; no cost or rollout date is stated. 2026-09-30 - the finance minister put the national portal at 572 services across 52 providers and about K9.8 billion collected since 2019. 2026-10-06 - the meteorological department and the agriculture ministry are building a national digital climate advisory service that sends farmers localised forecast and agronomic advice by text message.	MOVEMENT

Digitalisation

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digitalisation of sub-national government	**ICT infrastructure for local government**	2,000 devices were handed over for all 116 local authorities and eight were onboarded to the government service bus. The 2026 budget address carries the connectivity and electronic government commitments for local government. 2025-09 — the state technology institute handed 1,780 laptops and 220 desktops to the local government ministry for distribution to all 116 local authorities plus district and provincial offices. 2026-07 — eight local authorities were onboarded to the government service bus. Eight of 116 is the number worth keeping: equipment reached every authority and the platform reached seven per cent of them, which is the difference between hardware and a service.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digitalisation of sub-national government	**Digitalisation of local government records**	Eight of 116 councils are on the electronic council platform, one is live on the national portal, and all 116 are network-connected — three counts measuring three different things. Eight local authorities were onboarded to the council platform from June 2026; a March account names seven of a stated eight, and the platform's own launch date is not established (platform, councils, collections). One council went live as the first of 116 on the national portal; that is distinct from network connection of all 116 and from platform onboarding, and the three counts measure different things (portal). A constituency fund management system has data entry under way with full operationalisation stated for June 2026 (fund), and one town council was equipped with connectivity and telepresence in August 2026 with no programme size, cost or council list published (equipment).	MIXED three different council counts measuring three different things
Rural digital data capture	**Digitalisation of rural health clinics**	Satellite terminals were installed in rural public facilities and a government private fourth-generation network launched at a teaching hospital. The state buying foreign satellite capacity for the last mile sits alongside a government-owned private network build (terminals, network). The private network launched at a teaching hospital; clinician accounts at the launch site are operator statements, and no baseline or measured outcome is held (launch, coverage). Two connectivity strategies for the same problem — buying foreign satellite capacity and building a state network — running at once, with no source relating them. The 2026 budget address counted 525 satellite kits deployed, with no breakdown by facility type or district (address).	MOVEMENT
Rural digital data capture	**Digitalisation of rural primary schools**	A target of 2,500 additional schools connected by end-2026, against one completed rural school connection. The auditor general found the education ministry's electronic census software set aside as non-functional and replaced by an in-house spreadsheet tool — the repository's standing finding on data capture in schools, and a costly one. 2026-04 — the education ministry set a target of 2,500 additional schools connected to reliable internet by the end of 2026, prioritising rural and hard-to-reach areas. It is a target, not a rollout. 2026-08-06 — an operator connected a rural primary school's computer laboratory by satellite. One completed deployment against that target, with four months to run and no progress count published. 2026-09-15 — a three-year programme began connecting 70 schools by satellite with solar power, free for the first year only.	MOVEMENT
Rural digital data capture	**Digitalisation of rural registry offices**	A funding line for the integrated registration system sits behind computerisation of card, passport and citizenship issuance. 2025-08 — the registration department began computerising national registration card, passport and citizenship-document issuance with the state technology institute, targeting online applications including from the diaspora. 2025-09 — the 2026 budget address carries a funding line for the integrated national registration information system. Both describe the centre. Neither states how many district or rural registry offices have been reached, what equipment they hold, or whether a citizen away from a provincial capital can transact — which is the whole of what this indicator asks, and the record does not answer it.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Rural digital data capture	**Digitalisation of rural police stations**	Networking equipment for 40 police stations was delivered in February 2026 under a local-area-network and last-mile connectivity project. Routers, switches, access points and firewalls were delivered to the state ICT institute in February 2026 for deployment to 40 police stations nationwide, under a police local area network and last mile connectivity project intended to connect stations to a centralised system and move records and processes online. The equipment was supplied by a domestic ICT firm. The equipment is delivered rather than installed: no station list, timetable, budget or go-live statement is published, and no count of stations already connected is held.	MOVEMENT

Technology

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
AI	**Use of AI in government administration**	An implementing partner published a first-hand account of artificial-intelligence automation at the National Assembly, and the same finding is reported from two other African parliaments. That the same finding appears in three parliaments makes it a pattern rather than an incident (parliament). An artificial-intelligence for public good challenge closed applications in August 2026; it is a call for applications, with no award value, cohort size or deployment commitment by any of the five institutions stated (challenge).	MOVEMENT
AI	**Use of AI in sectoral management information systems**	A clinical system consolidated 12 million patient records across 2,000+ facilities as an artificial-intelligence foundation. 2026-10-12 — the technology ministry is piloting an artificial-intelligence career-guidance platform in the technical and vocational training system, expected to reach more than 17,000 young people. 2024-04 — the agricultural research institute launched an application using artificial intelligence to diagnose and forecast crop pests and diseases for smallholder farmers — the repository's first operational deployment inside a Zambian sectoral system. 2026-03 — the technology ministry signed a memorandum for an adaptive-learning pilot in secondary schools and vocational institutions. 2026-04 — a clinical system consolidated 12 million patient records across more than 2,000 facilities, framed by the state technology institute as the data foundation for artificial intelligence in the health management information system. The record layer arriving before the models is the right order, and it is the largest health dataset the repository holds for the country.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
AI	**Development of national / regional AI systems**	A feature-phone artificial-intelligence voice service is the only such application on file reaching people directly, and an international laboratory is on offer with no agreement signed. The voice service is cited as a deployed feature-phone application and is the only artificial-intelligence application on file reaching people directly (service). The laboratory was disclosed as an opportunity with no agreement signed; it is the only national-level artificial-intelligence institution on offer, and no domestic body exists (laboratory). A country whose only direct-to-citizen artificial-intelligence service runs over feature phones, and whose only institutional option is an offer, is where the record stands. 2026-09-17 — a UNDP programme reported country-hosted GPU capacity installed and activated with public institutions, with a critical-minerals application the highest-prioritised use in its six-country cohort and data access still to be confirmed. No capacity figure or host is stated, so the compute inventory stays unsettled.	NO CHANGE
AI	**Control of AI abuse**	A closed-circuit television bill and a national security command centre are on the record in civil-society monitoring, and the cyber agency artificial-intelligence remit is the first defined state mandate on file and is defensive. The bill and command centre are recorded in monitoring current to late December 2025 (bill). Artificial-intelligence-enabled trafficking and online scams were placed inside the cyber agency's response; it is the first defined state artificial-intelligence mandate on file, it is defensive, and it sits with the cyber regulator because no artificial-intelligence institution exists (remit, surveillance). The capital is listed among Chinese-supplied surveillance deployments in an eleven-country mapping; a widely quoted billion-dollar figure is a 2023 total across five countries, not a national figure and not current (safe city, mapping).	MOVEMENT
ICT Industry	**National capacity in DT-related production**	The regulator annual market performance report for 2022 is the latest market sizing held, with the article's own dollar conversions undated as to rate. It is the regulator's 2022 annual report, reaching the repository through a news account whose dollar conversions carry no stated rate date (report). Four years without a newer regulator market report, in a unit whose usage figures otherwise come from foreign compilers, is the measurement gap at the base of this whole ledger. 2026-09-15 — the regulator removed an operator: network and service licences were revoked for persistent regulatory, operational and financial failures.	NO CHANGE
Innovation ecosystem	**Technology hubs**	An innovation hub ran the nine-month pipeline that took a national team to global finals, and its chief executive says the talent pool is real but investment in research, technology and innovation is not. The chief executive's statement is his own account, given at the same event (hub). A digital economy incubator recruited facilitators and group coaches in August 2026; it is European Union-funded and delivered by a private hub with a non-governmental organisation, with no cohort size, budget or start date stated (incubator). One agricultural technology company exists because European traceability-compliance software was quoted at thousands to tens of thousands of dollars a month, on the founders' own account, with no revenue, farmer count, funding or independent evaluation held (company).	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Innovation ecosystem	**Tech startup ecosystem**	A Startup Bill was named by a ministry representative — its first and only mention in the repository — and a technology company listed on the domestic securities exchange. The bill's mention is the first and only one in the repository (bill). The listing is described as recent (listing), and a company founded in 2025 was profiled in July 2026 (company). A continental diversity report's third edition gives the female co-founder and chief executive share; the underlying report is not held and only the trade-press account is (diversity).	MOVEMENT

Capacity

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Literacy	**Digital literacy (civil service)**	146 officers were trained in digital skills and data protection across three district administrations — a single-province tranche rather than a coverage measure. The training covered three district administrations in one province (training). Naming it a tranche rather than a coverage measure is the point: no national civil-service digital training figure exists in this repository, and 146 officers in one province cannot stand for one.	MOVEMENT
Literacy	**Digital literacy (general population)**	ICT equipment was handed to a youth resource centre under a transformation centres initiative, with no cost, contract term, procurement route or trainee count published. The handover was made in August 2026 (centres, challenge). A digital literacy programme in six schools recorded core funding disbursed for the 2025 activity year; it is a commitment record rather than a delivery report, with no pupil count, equipment or outcome stated (schools). Two literacy items, neither with a published outcome, is the whole of general digital literacy here.	MOVEMENT
Training and skills	**DT-related training in secondary education**	Draft national ICT standards for the education sector were validated with a school hub installed; 927 teachers have completed integration training. The ministry computer science syllabus for secondary forms one to four is the instrument establishing digital training in secondary education. 2026-06 — 55 further teachers completed five-day ICT teaching-integration training at one secondary school, 927 cumulatively, reported by the implementing trust. 2026-07 — draft national ICT standards and guidelines for the education sector were validated and a school ICT hub installed. Standards and a cumulative teacher count are the two halves this indicator wants; what is missing between them is any national figure for how many of the country's secondary teachers can teach the syllabus.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Training and skills	**DT-related university facilities and qualifications**	Accreditation went to pilot on a quality-assurance system, and a university signed to host a continental-first artificial-intelligence institute. The Zambia Qualifications Authority Act, 2024 continues the authority and establishes the national qualifications framework with a higher education sub-framework that registers, verifies and evaluates university qualifications. 2026-06-02 — the higher education authority put its quality assurance management information system into pilot, digitising accreditation applications, after training 50 institutions' quality assurance and IT staff in March. 2026-06-09 — a university signed an agreement in Beijing to host the continent's first artificial-intelligence institute of its kind. A facility and a qualification system moving in the same month; no enrolment, accreditation throughput or graduate figure accompanies either.	MOVEMENT
Training and skills	**Graduates entering DT ecosystem**	A digital skills and capabilities component was board-approved within the acceleration grant, and a vendor academy training commitment was included in the artificial-intelligence data centre memorandum. The skills component was board-approved with its parent grant in September 2025 (component, appraisal). The vendor training reports no start date, cost, curriculum or intake process (academy). Both are components of larger instruments rather than programmes with their own delivery record, which is why neither carries an intake figure. 2026-08-31 — a ride-hailing company's STEM fellowship, begun in Zambia in 2024 with 30 students, expanded into a pan-African programme across six countries and selected 24 fellows from more than 600 applications, with a graduation and pitch day set for Abidjan on 17-19 September 2026. The 2026 cohort is smaller than the single-country intake it grew from, and no per-country allocation, financial value or outcome is published — an expansion in reach rather than in scale.	MOVEMENT
Research institutions	**Think tanks and academic departments contributing to DT policy**	The revenue authority signed a research memorandum and a non-disclosure agreement, so the terms — and whether taxpayer microdata moves — are not disclosed. The memorandum and the accompanying non-disclosure agreement were signed in July 2026 (memorandum). A research agreement whose confidentiality clause conceals whether taxpayer microdata moves is worth recording as exactly that, in a country whose data-protection regulator has no recorded action. The domestic base has a date and a founding source: the university's computing and informatics department was established in September 1998 with Belgian development funding through a university cooperation programme, which paid for the refurbishment, the equipment and two networked laboratories across two five-year phases meant to end in self-sufficiency. It opened with a postgraduate diploma and admitted its first degree students in August 2000.	MOVEMENT

Inclusion

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Access to services	**Citizen feedback portals**	Health charters linked facility accountability to the citizen support portal, and labour cases now reach districts with no office through it. 2025-01 — cabinet office launched the national citizen support portal. 2025-11 — national health service delivery charters formally linked facility-level accountability to the portal and to the anti-corruption commission's whistleblower system — a feedback channel gaining a service standard to be measured against, which is what turns a complaint box into accountability. 2026-08 — labour ministry staff were trained to handle labour cases through the portal, extending it to districts with no physical office. No case volume, resolution rate or response time for the portal is published, so its reach can be described and its performance cannot.	MOVEMENT
Access to services	**Citizen participation in policy**	More than 11,860 citizen submissions were handed to the President and became an enacted constitutional amendment. The 2016 constitutional amendment provides for citizen petition and public involvement in the legislative process. 2025-12-02 — more than 11,860 citizen submissions to the constitutional reform process were formally handed to the President, converting a nationwide consultation into a policymaking input. 2025-12-18 — a constitutional amendment was enacted creating a mixed-member proportional representation system with reserved National Assembly and council seats for women, youths and persons with disabilities. Consultation reaching enactment inside a month is the rarest sequence on this frame; what is not published is which of the submissions the amendment reflects.	MOVEMENT
Access to services	**Gender equity**	A constitutional amendment reserved National Assembly and council seats for women, over a cross-sector gender status report. The fifth cross-sector gender status report covers governance, poverty, education, health, employment, land and gender-based violence — the standing official measurement. 2025-12-18 — a constitutional amendment created a mixed-member proportional system with reserved National Assembly and council seats for women, the most consequential equity instrument on this ledger and one whose effect is testable at the next election. 2026-04 — specified sexual offences were made non-bailable. What the repository does not hold is any sex-disaggregated measure of digital access — of device ownership, internet use or digital skills — so gender equity here is read through representation and law rather than through technology.	MOVEMENT
Access to services	**Inclusion of persons with disabilities**	A national policy replaced the 2015 one and a constitutional amendment reserved seats for persons with disabilities. 2025-05 — a national policy on persons with disabilities replaced the 2015 policy. 2025-08 — a disability inclusive service site assessment tool was validated with the health ministry and partners, a measurement instrument rather than a statement of intent. 2025-12 — a constitutional amendment reserved National Assembly and council seats for persons with disabilities. Policy, a measuring tool and reserved representation in seven months is real movement. Nothing in the repository addresses digital accessibility specifically: no website standard, no assistive-technology provision figure and no disaggregated access measure is held.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Access to services	**Inclusion of refugees and IDPs**	Transfer of the refugee registration database to the home affairs ministry is provided for as a project subcomponent, and two project documents give different card counts and values. The safeguards framework gives US$6.5m and about 100,000 cards against the appraisal document's US$6m and about 150,000 (transfer); the divergence is recorded, not resolved (transfer, framework, engagement). The parent project became effective in December 2024, and no disbursement figure, enrolment count or implementation progress within the window is held (project, plans). Moving a refugee database from an international agency to a ministry is a change of controller, and the country's data-protection regulator has no recorded action of any kind.	NO CHANGE
Digital divides	**Bridging of digital divides**	The Universal Access and Service Fund has no fund size, levy rate, annual disbursement or cumulative tower count held for any year, under 2012 regulations that are its regulatory basis. A board assessment tour of projects in three provinces took place in 2026, and no fund size, levy rate, annual disbursement or cumulative tower count is held for any year (fund, projects, bill). The regulations were gazetted in June 2012 and are the fund's regulatory basis; the fund's own size, current levy collected and annual disbursement remain not held (regulations). Fourteen years of a universal access fund with no published financial figure of any kind is the single largest accountability gap in this ledger. 2026-09 — a three-year programme will connect an initial 70 public schools by satellite, adding solar power where schools are off the grid, run by the presidential delivery unit with private partners. No cost or school list is stated.	NO CHANGE

Data

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
National statistics	**National strategy for development of statistics**	A national data science training hub launched and a donor-funded nutrition platform moved into government structures. The second national strategy for the development of statistics runs 2023-2027, grounded in the Statistics Act. 2025-09 — the statistics agency launched a national data science training hub, explicitly aligned to the Act and the eighth national development plan, with bilateral support. 2026-04 — a donor-supported national information platform for nutrition transitioned from funded pilot into sustainable government structures. A pilot surviving the end of its funding is the test most such platforms fail, and it is the clearest evidence the strategy is producing durable capacity rather than projects.	MOVEMENT
National statistics	**Censuses and surveys**	The 2022 census national analytical report was published in August 2025, putting the literacy rate for those aged five and over at 62.6 per cent. The twelve-chapter national analytical report of the 2022 census was released in August 2025. It puts the national literacy rate for those aged five and over at 62.6 per cent, 65.3 for males and 60.1 for females, and 78.2 per cent in urban areas against 49.8 in rural ones; the rate for those aged 15 to 24 is 77.1 per cent, and the figure for those aged five and over has risen from 55.3 per cent in 2000. No release calendar is held, so what else the agency has scheduled is not established.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
National statistics	**Statistics from administrative data**	Digitising death notification raised completeness from 11.9 to 17.4 per cent and cut reporting time from six days to three. The Statistics Act, 2018 establishes the agency and the national statistical system, the framework administrative statistics are produced under. 2025-09 — a Zambia case study digitising the death-notification form raised completeness from 11.9 to 17.4 per cent and cut reporting time from six days to three. Both figures matter and the first is the sobering one: after digitisation, fewer than one death in five is captured. 2026-04 — a multisectoral nutrition information platform integrating administrative data moved into government structures, an example of the same chain working across sectors rather than within one.	MOVEMENT
Open data	**Use of open data**	A national spatial data infrastructure policy and portal was launched, and a national carbon registry launched with counts given by the permanent secretary. The spatial policy and portal were launched in the capital; the event date is inferred from a relative reference in a June 2026 report, and the policy document itself is not held (spatial, open source). The carbon registry's launch counts — more than 90 carbon projects at stages of approval, and bilateral agreements with three European states — are the permanent secretary's own (registry), and no public access, transaction count, custodian ministry or disclosure rule for its holdings is stated (holdings). A registry of tradeable environmental assets with no published disclosure rule is worth naming as the transparency question it is. 2026-09 — the finance ministry, the statistics agency and UNICEF launched a national research repository gathering research and evaluations onto one platform. No holdings count or licence is stated.	MOVEMENT
Use of satellite data	**Agricultural use of satellite data**	Two private platforms use satellite data with AI, for farm traceability and for soil monitoring, each on its founders' account. A Zambian platform pairs satellite imagery with artificial intelligence for smallholder traceability and market matching, described in a founder interview. 2026-09-22 - a second firm, founded in 2023, reads soil moisture, temperature and nutrients from satellite imagery and turns them into irrigation and fertiliser advice, and was placed second in the African Union's startup contest. Neither publishes a user count, revenue or independent evaluation.	MOVEMENT
Use of satellite data	**Meteorological use of satellite data**	An assessment was launched to strengthen aviation weather data (launch). The civil aviation authority and the international civil aviation organisation launched an assessment to strengthen aviation weather data (launch). It is an assessment, and the repository holds nothing on what data is currently produced or from what sources. A peer-review assessment of the meteorological department confirms operational use of geostationary satellite imagery — the baseline position. 2026-05-26 — a US$3.6 million initiative was launched to upgrade 21 surface stations and install four upper-air stations, closing data gaps that limit forecast and satellite-product accuracy. Ground stations are what satellite products are calibrated against, so this is the unglamorous half of satellite capability. 2026-07 — a peer-reviewed study evaluated four satellite rainfall products against 34 national stations and made operational recommendations. Independent evaluation of the products actually in use is rarer than the use itself.	MOVEMENT

Geopolitics

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
US / hyperscaler activities	**USA / hyperscaler MoUs, engagements and commitments**	The United States health financing memorandum was signed on 8 October 2026 after the specimen-sharing and patient-data clauses were removed, with a data sharing agreement limited to aggregated data beside it. The memorandum was reported shelved in May 2026 (shelving, exploitation, rejection). The minister denied the mining link on 15 February 2026 and was dismissed three days later without explanation. The 25-year data term is reported from a leaked draft rather than a text this repository holds, and the value is given as US$1.012bn in that draft and as up to US$2bn by the foreign minister in May 2026, with the two unreconciled (stress test, investigation). A country declining a health financing agreement over its data terms is rare in this frame and is recorded as the position it is. 2026-10-06 - the health minister said the health memorandum with the United States was finalised and due for signature after a specimen-sharing clause was removed. 2026-10-08 - Zambia and the United States signed the five-year health financing memorandum, put at US$2.49bn, after the specimen-sharing and patient-data clauses were removed. 2026-10-08 - a Zambian outlet reported a data sharing agreement signed beside the health memorandum, limited to aggregated and de-identified programme data.	MOVEMENT
China activities	**Chinese MoUs, engagements and commitments**	A bilateral seminar set out sovereignty conditions for digital cooperation with no agreement signed, against Chinese financing of the national data centre, the backbone and the towers programme. Sovereignty conditions were set out at the seminar and no agreement was signed; the source body is an excerpt rather than a full capture (seminar, ties, support). The existing relationship is not a matter of intention: Chinese concessional finance built the national data centre, funded the towers programme to the disbursement level recorded elsewhere in this report and left the backbone extension wholly undrawn, and the same vendor holds the artificial-intelligence data centre memorandum. Setting conditions on future cooperation while the installed base is already Chinese-financed is the position the record supports. An analyst's fieldwork account holds that Phase II of the Smart Zambia project, valued at US$333.2m for broadband and e-government, was cancelled in 2022 after the new government reviewed externally financed projects.	MOVEMENT
EU activities	**EU MoUs, engagements and commitments**	Over EUR 200 million in Team Europe investments and a 2026 partnership dialogue, on a raw materials rather than a digital agenda. A signed memorandum establishes a critical raw materials strategic partnership, the founding instrument of the relationship. 2025-11 — more than EUR 200 million in Team Europe investments was announced at a corridor business forum, deepening the raw materials memorandum and the connectivity commitments. 2026-02 — a partnership dialogue was held at which the Union welcomed an invitation to deploy an election observation mission and reaffirmed corridor and raw materials cooperation. None of the three carries a digital or data component of its own. That is the finding: the largest external partnership on this ledger is minerals and corridors, and digital appears in it nowhere.	MOVEMENT and not about digital

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Gulf/UAE activities	**Gulf MoUs, engagements and commitments**	A co-operation agreement with a Qatari holding group and a joint business council with the Saudi chambers, over a US$1.1bn mining stake. An investment of up to US$1.1 billion for 51 per cent of a copper mining company completed is the largest Gulf commitment in the country the repository holds. 2025-08 — the state industrial corporation signed a co-operation agreement with a Qatari holding group covering energy, agriculture, tourism, mining, transport and logistics, witnessed by the President. 2025-09-18 — a chambers body and the Saudi chambers federation signed a memorandum establishing a joint business council, an institutional channel distinct from the two deals. Digital and data appear in none of them. The Gulf relationship here is mining and trade.	MOVEMENT and not about digital
India activities	**India MoUs, engagements and commitments**	A comprehensive official bilateral brief lists memoranda and credit lines since 1964, with a mutual legal assistance treaty in negotiation. 2025-08-22 — a framework agreement was signed for a pharmaceutical manufacturing joint venture, 51 to 49 per cent with the Zambian side. 2025-11-14 — the prosecution authority and the Indian high commission held talks to finalise a mutual legal assistance treaty — a commitment being negotiated rather than concluded, and the one with the clearest data dimension, since mutual legal assistance is how evidence crosses a border. 2026-04 — India's foreign ministry published a comprehensive bilateral brief listing memoranda, lines of credit, trade and investment since 1964. It is the most complete external account of the relationship the repository holds and it is the counterparty's own.	MOVEMENT
Digital sovereignty	**Digital sovereignty**		NO EVIDENCE

Where the record is thin

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
National Computer Incident Response Team	The full Project Appraisal Document's component text, which would state whether a national response team is funded, hosted or operating; the wiki holds only the datasheet and strategic context paragraphs	not yet probed
Central Monitoring Centre	The text of the Cyber Security Act No. 3 of 2025 and any commencement or establishment order; the repository carries the Centre only as an embassy and civil-society characterisation, with no evidence it has been built, sited, staffed or funded	not yet probed
National cybersecurity policy or strategy	A published national cybersecurity strategy or the critical-information-infrastructure designation list required under the 2025 Act	not yet probed
Government cloud and data-hosting arrangements	The state ICT institute's hosting policy or a government cloud contract stating where ministry data and the portal and service-bus workloads physically reside	not yet probed
International transit and wholesale bandwidth pricing	The regulator's annual market performance report for a year after 2022, or an operator's published wholesale tariff; the last market report the wiki holds is for 2022	not yet probed
Power supply and backup at telecommunications sites	An operator or regulator statement of site electrification, generator and battery coverage, or reported outage hours attributable to grid failure	not yet probed
Electricity supply to data centres	A utility or facility-operator statement of contracted load and backup arrangements for the national data centre and any commercial facility	not yet probed
Satellite operator licence terms in Zambia	The regulator's licence award notice or fee schedule for satellite service providers; the held market report gives a continental fee range but no Zambian figure	not yet probed
4G and mobile broadband population coverage	A regulator coverage report by technology; the government's 92% and 94% coverage claims state no unit or measurement basis	not yet probed
Fixed and mobile broadband pricing	A price basket after the 2025 appraisal's statement that 5 GB of fixed broadband costs more than 12% of gross national income per head; no post-2025 Zambian tariff figure is held	not yet probed

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
System integrator contract award for the digital ID	The procurement award notice naming the integrator, contract value and delivery dates; the repository holds the March 2026 procurement opening and nothing after it	not yet probed
Outcome of the April 2025 mobile campaign for 3.5 million ID documents	A registration department or home affairs ministry closing report for the three-month campaign, giving registration cards and birth certificates actually issued	not yet probed
Refugee biometric registration card issuance	The refugee and host communities project implementation status report, which would show disbursement and whether biometric registration under the identity subcomponent has begun	not yet probed
Central bank national payment system statistics	A national payment systems annual or quarterly report giving mobile money and switch transaction volumes and values; the repository carries only inclusion rates quoted second-hand	not yet probed
Whether the seven pilot councils went live on the national portal by 2026-06-30	A local government ministry statement after 2026-06-30 listing councils live on the portal	not yet probed
Regulator annual or quarterly market performance report after 2022	A market performance report for 2023 or later; the only one held is the 2022 edition	not yet probed
A national earth-observation or satellite-data programme	A Zambian space or earth-observation policy, a national satellite data agreement, or the spatial data portal's dataset inventory naming its imagery sources	not yet probed
Data Protection Act statutory instruments and regulations	The Government Gazette carrying the Act's commencement order and any statutory instruments made under it on registration of controllers, transfer rules and breach notification	not yet probed
Data protection regulator enforcement record	The Office's annual report or a published register of controllers, complaints, breach notifications and enforcement decisions	not yet probed
Cabinet decision to repeal and replace the Data Protection Act 2021	The Cabinet decision or the gazetted amendment or repeal Bill; the repository carries only a civil-society report's statement of intent, current to late 2025	not yet probed
Cyber Security Act No. 3 of 2025, statutory text	The gazetted text of the Act, which would establish whether the interception mandate and central monitoring centre attributed to it are provisions of the Act	not yet probed
Enforcement outturn under the Cyber Crimes Act No. 4 of 2025	Charge, prosecution or conviction figures from the National Prosecution Authority or the Judiciary, or a ministerial statement to the National Assembly giving counts since 2026-07-18	not yet probed
Access to information law	A gazetted Access to Information Act or Bill; no held source states whether Zambia has one, and the repository carries no position at any date	not yet probed
Ratification of the AU Malabo Convention	The African Union list of signatures, ratifications and accessions, or a Zambian instrument of ratification	not yet probed
Parliamentary and public contestation of Zambia's data governance	Hansard for the sittings at which the cyber Acts and the data protection Act were debated; the repository holds two sources on this subject and one is a paywalled lede	not yet probed
National open data portal and open data policy	A government open-data portal with a dataset inventory and licence terms, or a Cabinet-approved open data policy; the repository holds only the geospatial portal	not yet probed
EU-Zambia digital cooperation	A European Commission or EU Delegation announcement, Global Gateway project fiche or financing agreement naming a Zambian digital investment; the repository holds zero Zambia sources on this subject	not yet probed
Legal basis for personal-data transfers between Zambia and the EU	A European Commission adequacy decision, or a Zambian data protection determination or guidance on cross-border transfer mechanisms	not yet probed
Any Gulf-state technology engagement with Zambia	A bilateral agreement, investment record or ministerial visit involving the UAE, Saudi Arabia or Qatar; nothing on file, the repository holding zero Zambia sources on this subject	not yet probed
Artificial intelligence budget line or implementation costing	The 2026 or 2027 national budget estimates showing an AI allocation, or a costed implementation plan annexed to the strategy	not yet probed
National artificial intelligence institution or agency	A statutory instrument or cabinet decision establishing a Zambian AI body; nothing names one, and the only institution on offer is the proposed international lab	not yet probed
National artificial intelligence compute inventory	A state ICT institute or ministry statement of installed government compute, or the technical annex to the vendor memorandum	not yet probed

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Government innovation or venture fund	A budget line, fund charter or disbursement record; the repository holds no Zambian public innovation fund of any kind	not yet probed
Technology hub inventory	A directory or count of Zambian innovation hubs; one hub is named anywhere in the repository, and long-standing hubs appear nowhere in it	not yet probed
Zambian startup funding totals	The underlying diversity report, or an African startup funding report with a Zambia line; only continental aggregates are held	not yet probed
ICT sector contribution to GDP	A statistics agency national-accounts release with an ICT sector share; the Presidential Delivery Unit called ICT one of Zambia's fastest-growing sectors with no figure behind it	not yet probed
Universal Access and Service Fund accounts	The regulator's annual report or the fund's own audited financial statements, giving the levy rate, fund balance and annual disbursement	not yet probed
National digital literacy rate or programme	A regulator or statistics agency ICT household survey reporting digital skills prevalence, or a named national digital-literacy curriculum document	not yet probed
Digital skills targets under the e-Government Plan 2023-2026	The plan itself, which the hub names but no held source reproduces or quantifies	not yet probed
Gender gap in internet use or mobile ownership	An industry association gender-gap country figure or a regulator or statistics agency survey disaggregating internet use by sex	not yet probed
Rural-urban internet use split	A regulator market report or household survey disaggregating internet use by residence; the repository gives only that 52.4% of the population is rural	not yet probed
Device affordability and data cost as a share of income	An affordability alliance or ITU affordability figure for Zambia; the repository holds only the appraisal statement that fixed broadband exceeds 12% of gross national income per head	not yet probed
Digital access for persons with disabilities	A national disability-inclusion policy or regulator programme document; the repository holds only individual ICT donations to two special schools	not yet probed
National broadband policy	An adopted Zambian broadband policy or strategy, or a government statement that one is in preparation with a date.	2026-02-01
Dedicated artificial-intelligence legislation	A Zambian Act, statutory instrument or regulator rule governing artificial intelligence.	2026-07-01
Source code, operating skills and exit for the Huawei-built government data centres	A Smart Zambia, INFRATEL or audit statement on source-code ownership, support contracts and exit terms for the Phase I data-centre systems.	2026-09-25
Data jurisdiction, portability and exit terms of the Huawei AI data centre and sovereign cloud memoranda	Publication of the May and June 2026 memoranda or of a contract that follows them.	2026-09-25

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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